Day 22 - Canada Goose, Black Creek, Charles Hildebrandt, Brown Benton

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 29 · Canada Goose Side Trail, near Limehouse

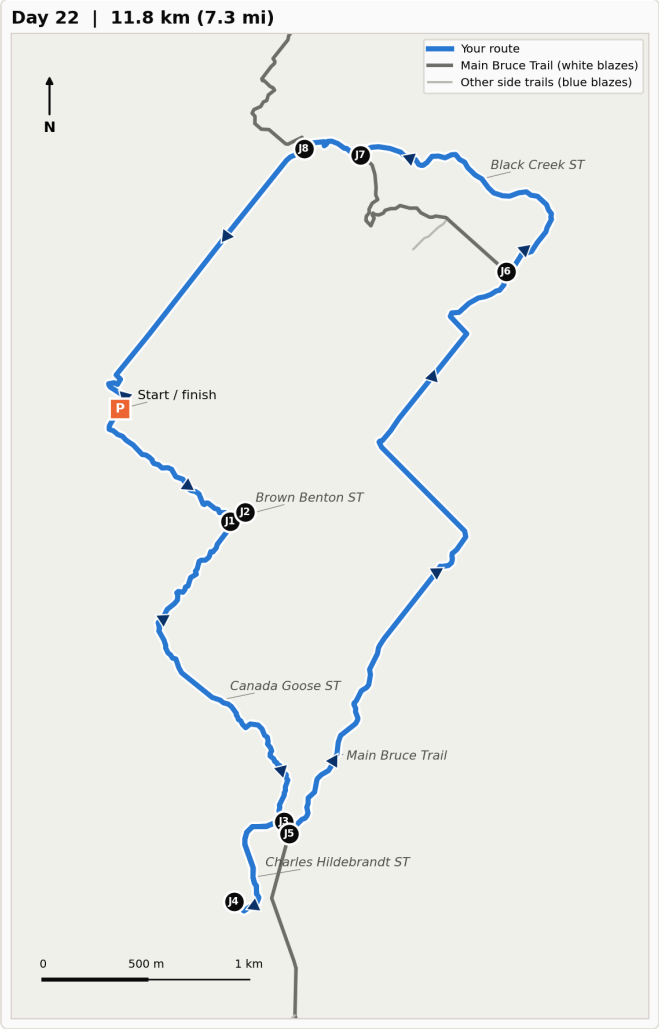
11.8 km / 7.3 mi	~3.3 h	7.1 km new	47 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Bruce Trail parking located on 22 Sideroad immediately west of Fourth Line. Provides access to the Canada Goose Side Trail. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day22_hike029.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Canada Goose Side Trail (4.8 km); Black Creek Side Trail (1.5 km); Charles Hildebrandt Side Trail (0.7 km); Brown Benton Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Bruce Trail lot on 22 Sideroad just west of Fourth Line. A trip report notes the trail meets the road at a blind curve with no shoulders, so take care stepping out of the trees.
- **Canada Goose Side Trail:** Runs about 3 km along an escarpment ridge roughly parallel to Fourth Line. Footing is described as challenging: rocks, wet spots, stumps and roots. It passes the old silo and stone barn foundations of a homestead and skirts a limestone quarry.
- **Black Creek Side Trail:** Credit Valley Conservation rates it difficult, following the creek through several forest types with steep grades in places; CVC lists dog walking on this trail.
- **Main trail and stiles:** The main trail crosses private land and uses stiles over fences; be ready to help Zappy over. Near Limehouse the main trail passes rock fissures and ladders at the Hole in the Wall, which CVC calls unsuitable for pets.
- **Road walking:** A stretch of the main trail and the final stretch of the Canada Goose Side Trail follow a road shoulder; keep Zappy close and walk single file facing traffic.
- **Short connectors:** No descriptions were found for the Charles Hildebrandt or Brown Benton side trails.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Bruce Trail parking located on 22 Sideroad immediately west of Fourth Line. Head south-west on the blue-blazed Canada Goose Side Trail.
0.9	0.6	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Brown Benton Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Canada Goose Side Trail goes off on your right.)
1.0	0.6	J2: End of the Brown Benton Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (On the east side of Fourth Line across from the Brown Benton Side Trail access point). Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.1	0.7	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Canada Goose Side Trail, heading south. (the Canada Goose Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
3.1	1.9	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Charles Hildebrandt Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Canada Goose Side Trail goes off ahead.)

3.7	2.3	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
3.8	2.4	J4: End of the Charles Hildebrandt Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking on the shoulder at the southeast end of the travelled portion of the…). Turn around and retrace your steps.
4.5	2.8	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Canada Goose Side Trail, heading south. (the Canada Goose Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
4.6	2.8	J5: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
7.7	4.8	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
8.2	5.1	J6: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Black Creek Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
9.7	6.0	J7: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
10.0	6.2	J8: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Canada Goose Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking in Limehouse at the intersection of 22 Sideroad and the Fifth Line). The next 1.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.8	7.3	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Hiking the GTA, Credit Valley Conservation and Ontario Nature Trails.